

NIFT 2026 — Official Syllabus & Exam Pattern

National Institute of Fashion Technology | Ministry of Textiles, Govt. of India | 18 Campuses

■ Programme-wise Exam Components

Programme	Stage 1 Components	Stage 2	Duration
B.Des	GAT (100Q, 120 min)	CAT (3 hrs) + Situation Test	GAT + CAT + ST
B.FTech	GAT Section A+B (150Q, 180 min)	Not Required	GAT only
B.FTech → B.Des	GAT Section A+B (150Q)	CAT (3 hrs) + Situation Test	All 3 required
M.Des (PG)	GAT (120Q, 120 min)	Studio Test + Interview	GAT + Studio

■ GAT — Section-wise Question Count

Section	B.Des (100Q)	B.FTech Sec A (100Q)	B.FTech Sec B (50Q)	M.Des (120Q)
Communication Ability & English Comprehension	40	40	—	30 + 30
Quantitative Ability	20	20	15	20
Analytical Ability	15	15	15	25
GK & Current Affairs	25	25	—	15
Case Study	—	—	20	—
Total	100	100	50	120
Duration	120 min			120 min

Marking (GAT): +1 correct / -0.25 wrong / 0 unanswered · Language: English or Hindi (CBT)

Marking (CAT): No negative marking · Pencil & paper · 3 hours · Scored on creativity, illustration, colour

■ GAT — Syllabus Topics

Communication Ability & English Comprehension	Reading comprehension, Grammar, Vocabulary, Sentence correction, Idioms, One-word substitution
Quantitative Ability	Class 10 Maths — Arithmetic (% , ratio, profit-loss), Algebra, Geometry, Statistics, Data interpretation
Analytical Ability	Logical reasoning, Pattern recognition, Series, Analogies, Problem solving, Spatial reasoning
General Knowledge & Current Affairs	Indian art & culture, Fashion history, Design movements, Textile industry, National & international current events
Case Study (B.FTech Sec B)	Read and analyse a fashion/design/business case study — answer analytical questions based on it

■ CAT — Creative Ability Test Topics (B.Des)

Complete the Scene	Given an object — add human/animal figures, create a scene, write a title
Comic Strip (4 boxes)	Illustrate a story: Morning routine / Journey to Mars / Me as a fish / Expedition emotions
Pattern & Fabric Design	Colour a given pattern for Festival/Meditation/Travel themes — explain colour choice in 60-80 words
Poster Design	Design poster with tagline for: Cyber Cafe, Book Shop, Social campaigns (SDG 2030, LGBTQ awareness)
Mascot Design	Create a mascot for campaigns: India Against Corruption / Pulse Polio / Keep City Clean
Visualise Abstract Words	Illustrate 5 words: Speed, Passion, Storm, Happiness, Love, Hatred, Tsunami, Summer
Perspective & Viewpoint	Bird's eye view of a park · Lizard-on-wall room view · 4 aircraft landing sketches
Process in 4 Steps	How to make tea / Paper folding into a boat / Placing a bulb on holder
Emotion through Colour	Express Sorrow, Happiness, Rebellious, Astonishment through colour compositions
Character/Costume Design	Tourist Guide uniform (cultural + functional) · If birds were frogs / frogs were birds

Packaging Design	Festival / Raksha Bandhan themed packaging · T-shirt print design
Scene Illustration	Sketch: Walking in snow/rain · Classroom during exam · Concert / Food festival · Sunset marketplace

■ Situation Test — Stage 2 (B.Des Shortlisted)

3D Model Making	Create a 3D model using given materials within a time limit — assessed on concept, finish, creativity
Material Manipulation	Innovate with provided materials: paper, cardboard, clay, fabric, wire etc.
Spatial & Design Ability	Demonstrate understanding of space, form, structure, proportion and visual balance
Innovation Under Pressure	Show originality, design thinking, and creative execution in a timed environment
Tips	Observe everyday objects · Sketch concept first · Practice combining different materials · Study NIFT toppers' strategies

■ Interview — Stage 2 (M.Des / Shortlisted)

Appearance	Wear smart casuals or semi-formals — avoid torn jeans, sleeveless shirts
Honesty	Never lie — if you don't know an answer, politely say 'Sorry, I'm not updated with this'
Eye Contact	Maintain eye contact · Greet everyone as you enter · Look at the panel, not the walls
Composure	Never argue — put your points politely · Stay calm under pressure

■ Eligibility Criteria

Criterion	Requirement
Qualification	12th pass or appearing — any stream (Arts, Science, Commerce)
Minimum Marks	No minimum marks required for NIFT UG entrance
Age Limit	Below 24 years (29 years for SC/ST/PwD)
Application Fee	General/OBC: ■2,500 · SC/ST/PwD: ■1,250
Campuses	18 NIFT campuses including Chennai, Delhi, Mumbai, Bangalore, Hyderabad, Kolkata